

Westhampton Finance Committee Meeting
October 20, 2015

Meeting opened at 7:00 pm

Present: Jackie Brodeur, Mary Cleary, Thomas Cleary, Aniko Giordano, Joe Pipczynski, Chevy Seney, and Celeste Whiting.

Members of Select board present: Phil Dowling, Jim Houston, and Art (Skip) Pichette

Chairperson Ellice Gonzalez was unable to attend.

Acting Chair: Joe Pipczynski

Acting Secretary: Chevy Seney

Motion to accept minutes of October 6, 2017, approved 7-0

Review of Correspondence was tabled until next meeting

Old Business

*Articles for upcoming Special Town Meeting (STM)

Discussion ultimately clarified that the Article #1 and its related Motion is to “approve the ability to borrow up to the amount” of the cost of the tanker truck. Timing of the borrowing of money and the reimbursement from the grant was discussed. Select board member Phil Dowling predicted approximately one month. Thomas Cleary made a motion to accept Article 1 as presented with the Motion. Seconded by Mary Cleary. Voted 7 yes, 0 no, 0 abstain.

Mary Cleary made a motion to accept Article 2 as presented. Seconded by Thomas Cleary. Voted 7 yes, 0 no, 0 abstain.

Mary Cleary made a motion to accept Article 3 as presented. Seconded by Aniko Giordano. Voted 7 yes, 0 no, 0 abstain.

*Protocol for STM that would include expenditure of Town funds

Art Pichette agreed that a cover letter would accompany every Article that recommends “transfer with language for intended Motion.” The cover letter would have the recommendation for each Article and lines for recording the finance committee votes. There was discussion about part practice. Also, discussed was the need to keep consistent records that could be defended in future meetings. It was agreed that the votes of the finance committee be posted with the warrant for the STM. This would make the vote available to participants at the STM. A goal for the future would be to post this information on the “interactive Town webpage.”

New Business

- FY17 Budget Guidelines

Celeste Whiting sought clarification on the “COLA.” Both Phil Dowling and Art Pichette stated that the use of that term in past communications had been a “misnomer.” They both agreed that the FY17 budget planning did not involve the calculation of a “COLA.” Joe Pipczynski asked if the Select board was viewing “2.5% as a standard increase.” Art Pichette said they did not “assume 2.5%.” Phil Dowling said that they “look across the board” when considering requests for budget increases. Jim Houston said, “It’s not a blanket 2.5.” He added that they “look at things totally.”

- Capital Planning Committee

Phil Dowling is a new member of this committee. This committee has not met for a while. Mary Cleary “encouraged the committee members to attend the remaining two budget workshops.” She also expressed concern for a “consistent stream of funding” for projects such as the safety complex. People in attendance think that a committee already exists for the safety complex project. There was brief discussion about the benefits that a stabilization fund might offer in funding capital projects.

No other issues were brought to the committee.

No time was established for the next meeting.

Motion to adjourn was made by Thomas Cleary. Seconded by Aniko Giordano.

Meeting adjourned at 8:05

Respectfully submitted,
Chevy Seney